Employee Leave Policy Guideline (Singapore)

Maternity, paternity, shared parental, National Service, medical and hospitalisation leave. As of 4 October 2026.

1. Purpose and scope

This guideline sets out how the company grants maternity, paternity, shared parental, National Service (NS), medical and hospitalisation leave in line with Singapore law. Where company policy is more generous than the statutory minimum, the more generous term applies.

- **Who it covers:** all employees on a contract of service. Eligibility conditions (service length, marital status, child's citizenship) are stated under each leave type.
- **Legal basis:** the Employment Act, the Child Development Co-Savings Act (government-paid parental leave), and the Enlistment Act and Reservist provisions (NS).
- **No retaliation:** no employee is dismissed, demoted or disadvantaged for taking leave they are entitled to.
- **Confidentiality:** medical and family information is shared only with HR and the approving manager, and only as needed.

2. Maternity leave

Eligible mothers get 16 weeks of paid maternity leave for a Singapore citizen child, or 12 weeks if the child is not a citizen.

Item	Rule
Entitlement	16 weeks (citizen child); 12 weeks (non-citizen child)
Service requirement	At least 3 continuous months with the company
Marital status	Legally married to the child's father
Pay	Company pays salary during leave and claims reimbursement from the Government; cap of S$10,000 per four weeks, inclusive of CPF
Notice	Inform HR as early as possible, with the expected delivery date and intended start date
Return to work	Resume the same role, or an equivalent one on no less favourable terms

If the mother does not meet the marriage or citizenship conditions, HR should check the exact entitlement with MOM before confirming it in writing.

3. Paternity leave and Shared Parental Leave (SPL)

Eligible fathers get 4 weeks of Government-Paid Paternity Leave, and both parents share a further 10 weeks of SPL for children born on or after 1 April 2026.

Item	Paternity leave	Shared Parental Leave
Entitlement	4 weeks	10 weeks shared; 5 weeks each by default, adjustable by agreement
Eligibility	Lawfully married to the mother between conception and birth, or within 12 months of the birth; Singapore citizen child	Both parents eligible and employed; Singapore citizen child

When to take	Within 12 months of birth	Within 12 months of birth, after maternity or paternity leave is fully used
Pay	Employer pays; Government reimburses up to S$2,500 per week, inclusive of CPF	Same cap of S$2,500 per week

For children born between 1 April 2025 and 31 March 2026, SPL is 6 weeks (3 weeks each by default). Plan cover early, since one household can take 16 + 4 + 10 weeks across two employees.

4. National Service (NS) leave

NS call-ups are protected: the company grants leave for in-camp training and other call-ups without using up annual leave.

- **Notice:** the employee gives HR the call-up notice as soon as it is received.
- **Pay:** salary continues during NS, and the company claims support from MINDEF under its pay-claim scheme.
- **Protection:** no dismissal, demotion or loss of benefits because of NS duty.
- **Scheduling:** employees may apply to MINDEF to defer where a genuine business or personal need exists; HR supports the application.
- **Return:** the employee resumes the same or an equivalent role after training.

5. Medical and hospitalisation leave

Paid sick leave grows with length of service, up to 14 days outpatient and 60 days in total including hospitalisation after 6 months.

Months of service	Outpatient sick leave	Total incl. hospitalisation
3	5 days	15 days
4	8 days	30 days
5	11 days	45 days
6 or more	14 days	60 days

- **Medical certificate (MC):** required from a registered doctor or dentist for any paid sick leave.
- **Notice:** the employee informs the manager or HR of the absence within 48 hours.
- **Pay:** gross rate of pay for each day of approved sick leave.
- **Hospitalisation days** are part of the 60-day total, not on top of the 14 outpatient days.
- **Misuse:** a false MC is a disciplinary matter.

6. Application and approval process

1. The employee submits the leave form to the manager and HR, with the MC, call-up notice or expected delivery date as supporting proof.
2. The manager confirms cover arrangements within 3 working days.
3. HR checks eligibility and balance, and confirms approval in writing.
4. For parental leave, HR files the government reimbursement claim and keeps the records.
5. HR keeps leave records for the period required by law and company policy.

Quick answers

- *Can sick leave be carried forward?* No, unless company policy says otherwise.
- *Can parents split SPL unevenly?* Yes, if both agree and register the change.
- *Does NS leave reduce annual leave?* No.

7. Items to verify before publishing

The parental leave figures were checked against 2026 sources. The NS and sick leave details come from general knowledge and need confirming.

- Confirm NS pay-claim rates and steps with MINDEF.
- Confirm which sick leave rules apply to managers and executives with MOM.
- Confirm the maternity pay arrangement and reimbursement caps on the MSF and MOM sites.
- Have the final policy reviewed by your legal or HR adviser.

Sources: MSF, 10 weeks of Shared Parental Leave from 1 April 2026 (msf.gov.sg); Lockton, Singapore paid family leave update (global.lockton.com); Raffles Corporate Services, reimbursement guide (rafflescorporateservices.com); Glints, paternity leave guide (talenthub.glints.com).